Advanced & Post Reading Material (APRM)
EPP-II 2025-26 GLA U, Mathura
Module-I (Verbal Ability)

Voice

The voice of a verb indicates whether the subject performs the action (active voice) or is acted upon (passive voice).

* Active Voice: The subject is the doer of the action "e.g., The student wrote the essay."
* Passive Voice: The subject receives the action "e.g., The essay was written by the student."

We use passive voice-

- When the doer is unknown
- When the doer is not important
- When the emphasis is on the action and its recipient(s).

For instance:
1-*My purse was stolen* when I was traveling on a local train. (the doer is unknown)
2-*The assignment should be finished* by tomorrow unless you want to face the manager's wrath!
(The emphasis is on the action and its recipient)

- An active voice sentence cannot be turned into a passive voice one unless there's an object (recipient of the action) in the active voice sentence.

- Some active voice sentences might have two objects i.e. two recipients of an action. In that case, any of the recipients could take place of the subject in passive voice.

3-He tells *me all his secrets. (Active)*
All his secrets are told to me by him. / I am told all his secret by him. (Passive)

4-The teacher showed *the students the answers*. (Active)
The students were shown the answers by the teacher. / The answers were shown to the students by the teacher. (Passive)

5-My mom lent *me her car*. (Active)
I was lent my mother's car by her. / My mother's car was lent to me by her. (Passive)

Formation of Passive Voice:
The passive voice is formed using a form of the "be" verb, followed by the past participle form (Verb 3rd form) of the main verb.

Simple Present Tense
7-She writes the letter. *(Active)*~ **The letter is written** by her.
8-**The report is prepared** by the organizing committee.
9-**Roadblocks are set up** across all the streets in the city every time there are demonstrations by the minorities.
10-**Most of the grunt work is done** by the people living in the slum while **the profits are made** by those sitting in the comfort of their affluent office.

Present Continuous Tense
11.She is writing the letter. *(Active)*~ **The letter is being written** by her.
12. **The experiments are being conducted** by the scientist.
13.**She is being considered** for candidacy in the presidential election.
14.**The CCTV footage is being scrutinized** minutely as the case which was put on ice for five long years has been reopened.
(Please note, in the above example, all three clauses are in the passive voice. The first clause is in the present continuous tense, the second clause is in the simple past tense, and the third clause is in the present perfect tense)

Present Perfect Tense
15.She has written the letter. *(Active)*~ **The letter has been written** by her.
16.**The research has been reviewed and approved** by the board of directors.
17.**The miscreants have been caught red-handed,** and **a local witness has been subpoenaed** to testify before the jury.
18.**The financial fiasco has been taken care of** by the newly appointed committee members.

Simple Past Tense

18.She wrote the letter. *(Active)*~ **The letter was written** by her.
19.**All four of the employees who were convicted** of fraud and money embezzlement **were proved/proven guilty.** (Both clauses use passive voice in the simple past tense).

20. **Queen Elizabeth II was crowned** queen in 1953.
21.When I asked the hedge-fund folks who they would like to speak to vis-a-vis their next project, **your name was** unanimously **agreed upon**.

Past Continuous Tense

22.She was writing the letter. *(Active)*~T**he letter was being written** by her.
23. The court was adjourned because **the autopsy data was** still **being analyzed**. (P.S. the first clause also uses passive voice, but in the simple past tense)
24.When the guests arrived, **dinner was being cooked**.
25.**The locals were being interrogated** thoroughly as they had claimed that the fire was an arson.

Past Perfect Tense

26. She had written the letter. *(Active)*~ **The letter had been written** by her.
27.**The results had been finalized** before the case was reviewed. (P.S. the second clause uses passive voice in the simple past tense and clarifies that the action in first clause is the former action and happened before the one in the second clause.)
28.**Queer people had been put through** shock therapy and conversion therapy until these barbaric pseudoscientific therapies were finally banned. (The second clause uses passive voice in the simple present tense, suggesting that the action in it happened after the one in the first clause.)
29.When I joined the committee, I got to know that **the documents** which could prove the forgery committed by the director **had been stashed away** in the manager's safe.

Future Simple Tense

30.She will write the letter. *(Active)*~ **The letter will be written** by her.
31.**The project will be launched** next month.
32.**Liam and Arjun will be married** by the priest of their own congregation.
33.**Your name will be recommended** for the post of Assistant Director to the panelists as **some new responsibilities will be handed over** to you very soon.

Future Perfect Tense

34.She will have written the letter. *(Active)*~ **The letter will have been written** by her.
35.**The session will have been concluded** by the end of this week.
36.**We will have been offered jobs** in the next three to four years. (Note that this passive voice construction can be rewritten as: "**Jobs will have been offered to us**…" because there are two recipients of the verb "offer": "us" and "jobs". This would be clearer if we look at how the active voice structure of this sentence: *They/ The companies will have offered us jobs in the next three to four years.)*

Modal Verbs* and *Modal Perfect

37. She can write the letter. *(Active)*~ **The letter can be written** by her.
38. **The exam could be taken online**.
39. **The work might be completed** in a week.
40.**The assignment should have been completed** by now.
41.**The assassin might have been shot** by a friend of the victims.
42.**We would not have been invited** if we hadn't done what they asked us to do.
43.We will do **what must be done.**
44.**Life should be led** with love and faith.
45.**The signature must have been forged** by her friends.
46.**The project should not have been assigned** to him since he mostly ends up bungling his tasks.

Passive Voice with Reporting Verbs

Reporting verbs (e.g., say, believe, think, know, report) are often used in the passive voice.

47. **She is said to be** a brilliant scientist.
48.**Rabindranath Tagore is known as** Gurudev.
49.**14th February has been declared to be** a holiday.
50.**It is believed** that we reap what we sow.
51.**It has been suggested** to us that we cordon off the crime scene.
52.**The man in my neighborhood** who went to prison for killing his business partner **was** generally **thought to be** a nice person.
53.**She was announced** as the next CEO.
54.**His actions were ruled** illegal in the hearing.
55.**It was claimed** that the drug store was selling medicines which were past their sell-by dates.

Passive Voice with Verbs followed by prepositions:

56.The committee unanimously agreed upon your name: Your name **was** unanimously **agreed upon**.
57.The crisis needs **to be dealt with** urgently.

58.The plan of moving to Riverdale from Greendale **has been opted out**.
59.The boy **who was charged with** murder escaped from prison.

Passive voice for Imperative Sentences:

In this case, we either use reporting verbs like *ask*, *tell, request, order, advise* etc. or use the structure: Let+ recipient of the action+ be+ Verb 3rd form

60.Close the door. ~ **Let the door be closed./ You are asked** to close the door.
61.**You are advised** to present a detailed report of your research to the committee.
62.**Let the order be issued**.
62**You are requested** to finish the project by tonight midnight at any cost.

Passive Voice in the case of the verbs which are not directly acted upon by the subject, but by another doer:

63. They made us do the grunt work on a meagre salary. ~ **We were made to do** (often means, "forced to do") the grunt work on a meagre salary.
64.I will **get my hair trimmed** today (by my stylist). (Not "I will trim my hair" unless you yourself cut your own hair.)
65.I will **have the work done** (by them/ by others) before we leave office.
66.**We were made to steal** the documents at gunpoint.

Passive Voice with Get:

The verb "get" can be used in the passive voice, particularly in informal contexts, but it often carries a slightly different meaning than the "be" passive. We use the "get passive" especially in informal speaking. When we use the "get passive", we tend to emphasize the nature of the action itself, or the person involved in the action:
67. **He got (was) fired** from his job.
68.**She got (was) promoted**.
69.**My dress got (was) stained** at the restaurant.
70.**The houses got (was) damaged** in the cyclone.
The "get passive" implicates a sense of immediacy vis-a-vis the consequence of an action.

Passive Voice in Infinitives:

71.We need to take these pills on time. ~ The pills need **to be taken** on time.
72.I want the work **to be finished** today.
73.The furniture was supposed **to be moved** to the new house, instead **it was sold** to the neighbours. (The second clause also uses passive voice in simple past tense.)

Uses of the Passive Voice:

* When the doer of the action is unknown or unimportant: (e.g., The window was broken.)
* When the focus is on the action or the receiver of the action: (e.g., The treaty was signed yesterday.)
* In formal and academic writing: The passive voice can create a more objective and impersonal tone. (e.g., The data is analyzed using statistical methods.)
* To avoid blaming someone directly: (e.g., A grave mistake has been made.)
* In scientific writing: Often used to emphasize the process or experiment rather than the researcher. (e.g., The solution was heated to 80 degrees Celsius.)

When to Avoid the Passive Voice:

While the passive voice has its uses, overuse can make writing sound awkward, indirect, and difficult to read. In general, prefer the active voice when:
* The doer of the action is known and important: (e.g., Instead of "The report was written by the manager," write "The manager wrote the report.")
* You want to make your writing more concise and direct because active voice is generally more concise.
* You want to create a more engaging and lively tone because active voice tends to be more dynamic.